

Periodic table of elements

The periodic table is a useful way of organizing the elements. It arranges the elements in order of their atomic number, which is the number of protons in the nucleus of an atom, and is unique to every element. The table also divides the elements into rows, called “periods”, and columns, called “groups”. Dmitri Mendeleev, the chemist who devised the table, arranged the elements based on the similarity of certain physical and chemical properties.

[illegible]